

Nielsen Norman Group

Heuristic Evaluation

Workbook

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

<https://www.nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics/>

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Evaluator:

Date:

Product:

Task:



Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

Does the design clearly communicate its state? Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?



Issues

The design clearly shows the purpose and use of the prototype through simple navigation labels such as Maps, Home, Calendar, and Profile. These features help users understand the app easily. However, the app still lacks detailed instructions or guides that could help first-time users become more familiar with the system. In terms of feedback, the scheduling feature provides confirmation messages, but other parts of the app still need clearer and more consistent feedback after user actions.

Recommendations

The app could improve by adding clearer feedback and simple guides for first-time users so they can understand the features more easily. Adding loading indicators and confirmation messages would also help users know what is happening in the system.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design? Do the design's

controls follow real-world conventions?



Issues

The prototype uses simple words, familiar icons, and many images that help users understand the purpose of the app more naturally. The design follows real-world conventions, making it easier for users to recognize the functions of each feature. Because of its simple layout and understandable terms, users can easily navigate the application without confusion.

Recommendations

The design should continue using simple and familiar words, icons, and layouts so users can understand the app naturally. Organizing information more clearly would also make navigation easier for users.

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● User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action? Is
- *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

Most features in the prototype still lack user control and freedom because there are only limited exit, reset, undo, and redo options. Although the app mainly focuses on discovering places and scheduling trips, users may still accidentally perform actions that they want to cancel or change. This is especially important in booking hotels, restaurants, and resorts where users may need to edit or cancel their decisions.

Recommendations

The app could add more options such as cancel, back, or edit buttons so users can easily correct mistakes or change decisions, especially when scheduling or booking trips.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

The prototype generally follows common design conventions because of its simple and easy-to-understand interface. However, some parts of the app use different visual styles and layouts, especially in the bottom navigation and interface sections. These inconsistencies may confuse users and affect the overall user experience.

Recommendations

The prototype would look more organized if the same colors, layouts, and button styles were consistently used throughout the app to avoid confusing users.

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Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

The app only provides confirmation and conditions during the login and signup process. Other features still lack proper error prevention tools. Since the app involves scheduling and booking, it is important to prevent users from making accidental mistakes before completing actions.

Recommendations

The app should include more confirmation prompts and warnings before users complete important actions to help prevent accidental mistakes or incomplete inputs.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

Some parts of the app use similar layouts and repeated feature designs, which help users become familiar with the interface. Because commonly used functions are visible and recognizable, users do not need to memorize too many steps while navigating the app.

Recommendations

Keeping important buttons and features visible at all times would help users navigate the app more easily without needing to remember too many steps.

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Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

The app is designed to be simple and accessible for different types of users. Its straightforward interface allows users to use the app easily. However, the efficiency of the experience still depends on how users interact with the app because advanced shortcuts or personalized features are still limited.

Recommendations

The app could become more efficient by allowing users to save favorites or quickly access frequently used features for a smoother experience.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

The prototype mainly focuses on the necessary content and avoids adding too many unnecessary elements. Its minimalist design helps users understand the app more clearly. However, some sections may still be improved to make the interface look cleaner and more visually balanced.

Recommendations

Improving the spacing, alignment, and overall arrangement of elements could make the interface look cleaner and more visually balanced while still keeping its simple design.

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Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

The current prototype still lacks proper error messages and recovery options. However, these features are important because they help users understand problems and guide them on how to fix mistakes quickly.

Recommendations

Adding clear error messages with simple explanations and solutions would help users understand problems and recover from mistakes more easily.

10 Help and

Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

The prototype currently does not provide help or documentation features. However, these can still be added in the settings or support section to guide users whenever they need assistance while using the app.

Recommendations

The app could include a simple help section or FAQ page so users can quickly find guidance whenever they need assistance while using the system.